Pics from [The Fruit Pearl of Fungi: Blue Oyster Mushrooms]() and [Pearl Oyster Mushroom Spawn (Pleurotus ostreatus) | Little Acre – Little Acre Mushrooms]()

Pleurotus ostreatus, commonly known as Oyster Mushrooms, is a prized edible and medicinal mushroom found and cultivated throughout the world. The species has been found to contain the cholesterol-lowering drug lovastatin. Named Oyster mushrooms due to the fact the cap looks like the Oyster shellfish. This mushroom is very resilient, and has been known to break down very complex organic materials, oils, pollutants, and even some plastics. This makes it one of the best bio-degraders in the world. Oyster mushrooms have been used to treat soil that had been polluted with diesel oil. The mushroom was able to convert 95% of the oil into non-toxic compounds. One of the coolest mushrooms around, despite being somewhat common.

These mushrooms are commonly growing in clusters found on dying or dead hardwood/deciduous trees. Though they can be found on living trees, they are not parasitic. They are growing on the tree because the tree is dying, and these mushrooms are decomposing it. These mushrooms are very beneficial to the forest ecosystem because they decompose dead trees quickly so they can return back to the soil and revitalize it further. They are most commonly found on dead and decaying trees.

[Pleurotus ostreatus - Wikipedia]()

Never consume mushrooms you aren't 100% sure of! This quick writeup is meant to be informative. If you wish to find and consume mushrooms from the wild, ensure you have the correct mushroom. I am not responsible if you attempt to eat a mushroom that looks like a mushroom from this pack, as there can be potentially many different poisonous lookalikes. If you wish to do your own mushroom hunting, check out some mushroom guide books local to your area (ie A Field Guide To Edible Mushrooms Of The Pacific Northwest if you live in the PNW). You can also try to find local guides who do mushroom hunts where you can learn more about mushrooms in your area.